

Advanced Concepts

Helmut Simonis

Constraint Based Production Scheduling

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Key Points



- We present some more advanced concepts in scheduling
- These occur in more specialized problem areas
- Typically require more work on modelling
- Solver support may be limited

- ## Slide 6

Slide 7

Relation to TSP

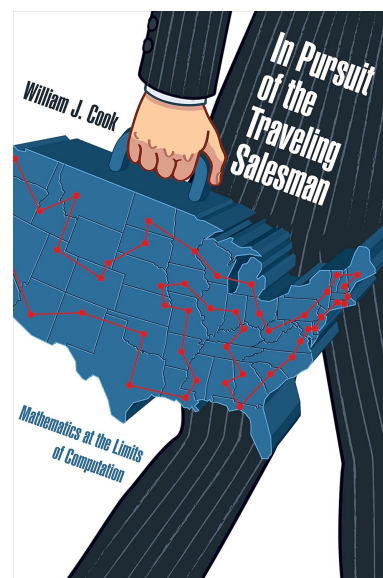


- Computing the optimal sequence of setup times is a variant of the *Travelling Salesman Problem (TSP)*
- Another of the classical hard combinatorial problems
- Due to the structure of the data, setup-time problems often are simpler to solve
 - Changing between very similar products needs no setup-time
 - Using a simple rule about product compatibility produces best results
 - Example: dark-chocolate → milk chocolate → white chocolate → milk chocolate → dark chocolate
- Problems get more difficult when release/due dates need to be respected
- This is the equivalent to the *VRPTW (Vehicle Routing Problem with Time Windows)*

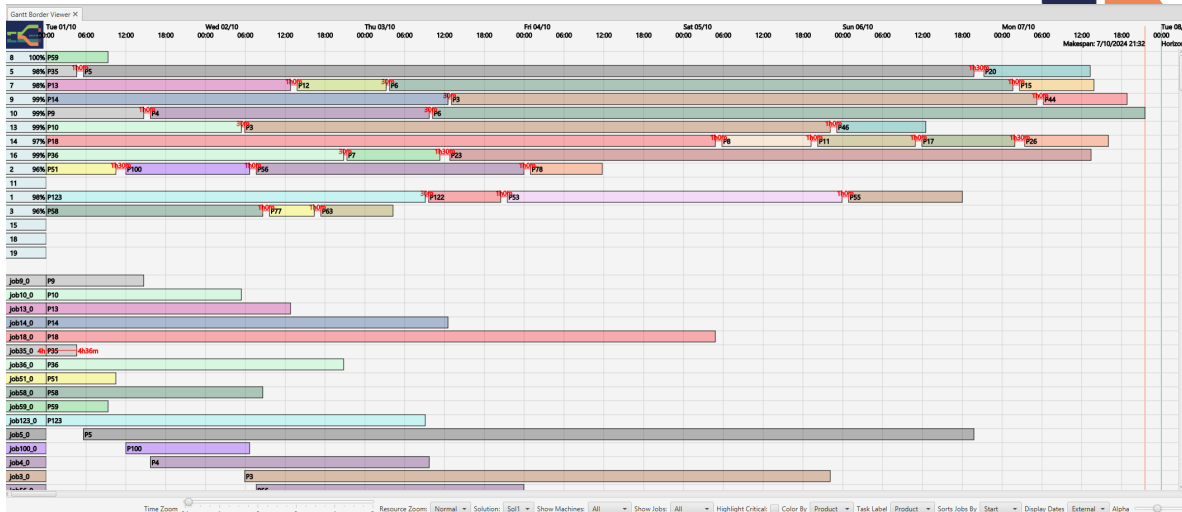
Xmas Shopping Hint



- W. Cook. *In Pursuit of the Travelling Salesman*. Princeton University Press, 2011
- Entertaining general science presentation of the TSP and related issues



Setup Times Constraints can be Included in Model



- Shown in Machine Gantt chart, enable display in Layout tab
- So far, only in CPO, not in CPSat model

Related Problem: Forbidden Transitions X



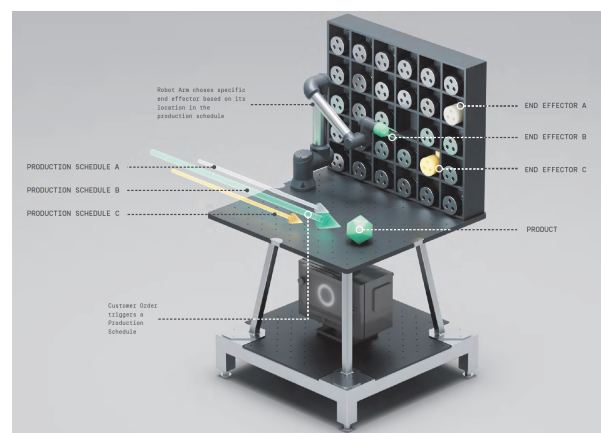
- For safety reasons, it may be forbidden to change from some product to some specific other products
- Contamination risk is considered too high
- Examples
 - In food production: Is this product peanut free?
 - In food production: Directly changing from dark to white chocolate is not allowed
 - In chemical plants: Contamination may lead to explosions
- These transitions are called *forbidden*, and must be avoided
- Careful, it is easy to paint yourself into a corner!

- Really two different problems
 - In one, the resources are in fixed locations, and we transport the jobs between the locations
 - In the other, the tasks are in fixed locations, and we transport the resources between them

Transportation of Jobs

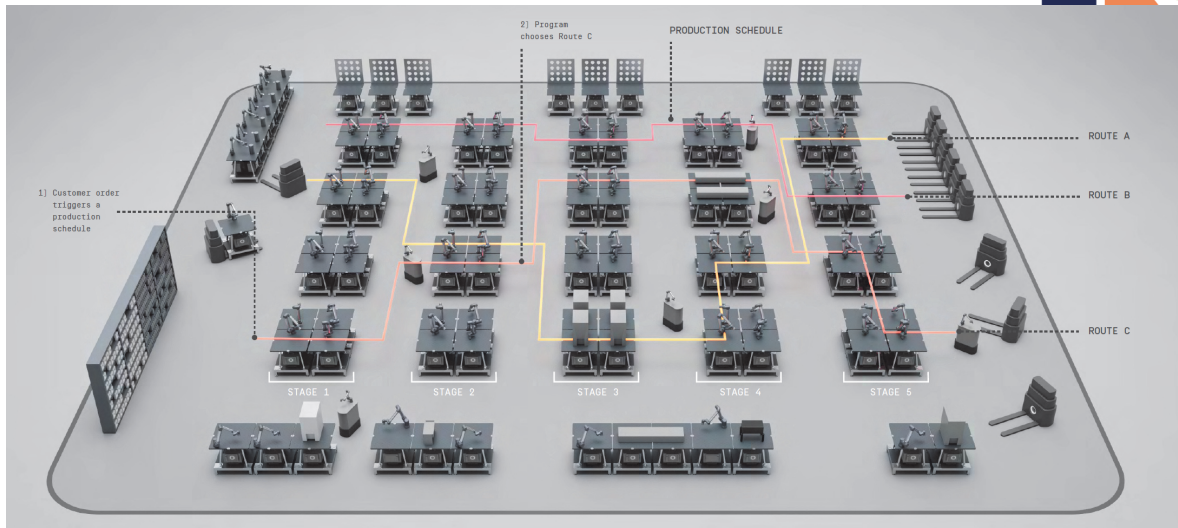


- Example from a project with J&J in Limerick
- Considering a *factory of the future* based on agile machines
- Robots that can be configured to perform many different tasks
- These robots may be inside one or more factories
- How to arrange them to minimize impact of transport on production



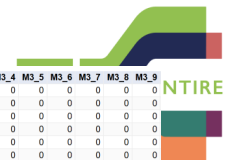
from J&J

Layout of Factor in Matrix Form



- Materials are transported between stations by moving robots
- Layout of factory determines delay caused by transport

Inclusion in Model (✓)



Row	M0_0	M0_1	M0_2	M0_3	M0_4	M0_5	M0_6	M0_7	M0_8	M0_9	M1_0	M1_1	M1_2	M1_3	M1_4	M1_5	M1_6	M1_7	M1_8	M1_9	M2_0	M2_1	M2_2	M2_3	M2_4	M2_5	M2_6	M2_7	M2_8	M2_9	M3_0	M3_1	M3_2	M3_3	M3_4	M3_5	M3_6	M3_7	M3_8	M3_9	
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2	M0_1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
3	M0_2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	2	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
4	M0_3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	3	2	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
5	M0_4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5	4	3	2	1	2	3	4	5	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
6	M0_5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	5	4	3	2	1	2	3	4	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
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44	M4_3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5	4	3	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	0	0	0	0	0		
45	M4_4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	5	4	3	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	0	0	0	0		
46	M4_5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0																										

More Complex Variant X



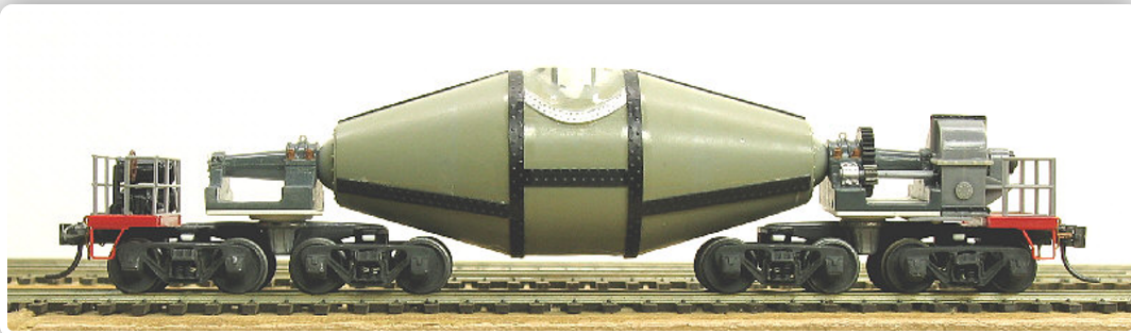
- Schedule the moving robots as well
- Assume that an empty robot travels much faster than a loaded one
- We can treat the robots as a machine choice resource for the transportation tasks

Even More Complex Variant X



- Schedule the moving robots as well
- They move at the same speed empty and loaded
- We can bring them from the end of one transport task to the start of the next one
- This is a vehicle routine problem
- In some industries, this is the harder problem than scheduling the plant itself
 - Torpedo scheduling in steel plant: rail cars holding molten steel, quantities limited

Torpedo Scheduling (CP 2016 Challenge)



(from ACP Website <http://cp2016.a4cp.org/program/acp-challenge/>)

ENTIRE EDIH

Production Scheduling

Slide 19

Scheduling Service Visits X



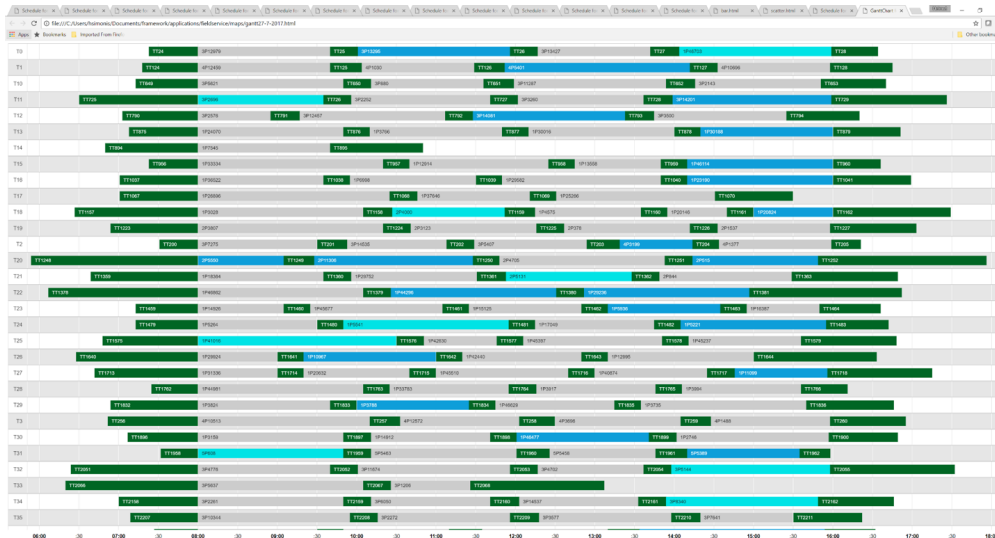
- Based on a project with UTRC-I, UTRC, OTIS
- Schedule visits to maintain equipment installed in customer premises
- Resources are the service engineers
- They have to travel between locations and perform work there
- The tasks are the maintenance operations required to keep equipment working
- Also called *Traveling Repair-person Problem*

ENTIRE EDIH

Production Scheduling

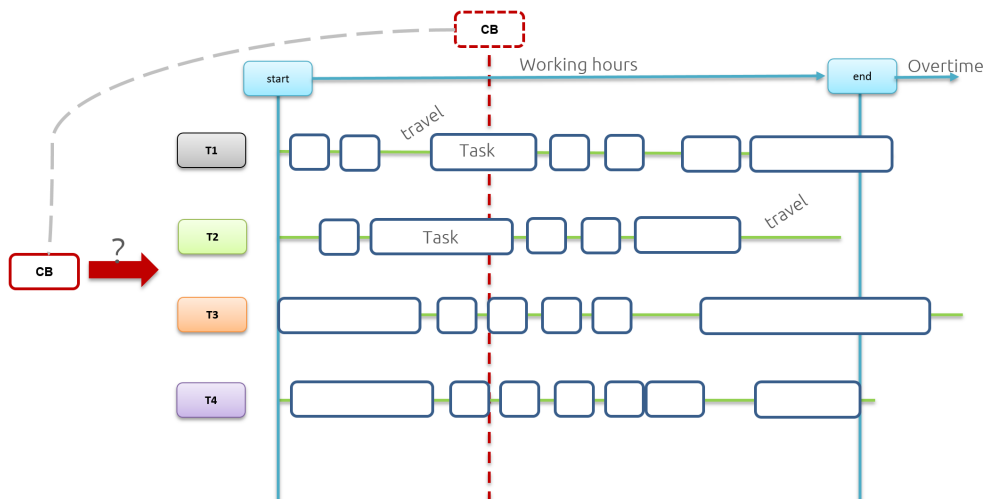
Slide 20

Planning Maintenance Visits for Service Personnel



- Include single day trips, multi-day tours
- Most of the time spent at customer locations

Re-scheduling Problem



- How to react when a customer is trapped in an elevator
- All your engineers are on service calls
- *Who you gonna call?*



- This will be described in more detail in a new course
- AI Fundamentals: Skill Development Program on Transportation Optimization
- Arriving in 2025 at this location

Summary



- We presented some more advanced topics
 - Sequence dependent setup
 - Transportation time
- Not available in every solver
- Useful concepts when dealing with specific scheduling problems
- Leading to another *Skills Development Program*